

pooka

"What is truth, but something we all agree upon? So, if we all agree upon a lie, isn't it then truth?"

Jester, rascal, fool, annoying brat, ne'er-do-well, and even philosopher have all been terms used to describe pooka. They can also be among the most charming and congenial of the Kithain and, ironically, the most truthful. They wear their

hearts on their sleeves; with a pooka what you see is what you get. They love pranks and play, and they hate hard work and meanness.

They play the part of the court jester, poking fun at authority figures and tearing down the walls and facades we all build to separate ourselves from one another. Every pooka has a close bond with a particular animal, and this kinship expresses itself both physically and through the pooka's personality.

In early tales, the pooka was a carefree spirit who enjoyed playing minor pranks and teasing mortals. Christian dogma later changed the pooka into a servant of the Devil — a lazy ne'er-do-well, full of lies and treachery, sometimes leading the unobservant and slow-witted to their deaths. Humans have always dreamed of a better, more carefree life. They envied the animals who could spend the day in seeming leisure, sleeping in the sun, grazing when they wished, and prancing and romping through the fields and trees, with nary a care in the world.

The pooka do their best to bring wonder and joy to the hearts

of mortals and changelings alike. They do whatever they can to dispel sadness wherever they find it, usually through jokes and tomfoolery. On the surface, it may seem that a pooka's life is

nothing more than a blur of happy chaos. The truth is often something very different. Despite their hijinks, they often see the world more clearly than others and they can harbor a deep melancholy they find hard to shake. Pooka fear Banality and the mundane even more than other changelings. They are acutely aware of the pain and suffering that surrounds them and want nothing more than to make it all go away. Their pranks and eccentricity are their ways of dealing with this, so for them, no joke is too low, no gag too crude, as long as it gets a laugh. Wherever they go, they bring laughter and confusion.

Truth is a curious thing to pooka. Anything they say is likely to be peppered with lies, half-truths, and misinformation. Their inability to speak the truth is well known to all Kithain. It is the primary weapon they use to combat Banality. Truth, after all, is often not very exciting or happy, therefore pooka lie. They mean no harm by it. They simply can't help themselves. Every word a pooka speaks is not always entirely false, and they often bury deeper truths within their deceptions. Most pooka do not use the same method of telling falsehoods, but rather mix it up, making deciphering pooka-ese all the more difficult. A pooka may speak in opposites, or exaggerate, or mix in outright falsehoods to anything he says.

Appearance: Nearly all pooka have physical traits relevant to the animal they share kinship with: tails, ears, beaks, whiskers, or feathers, and many have a fine layer of fur or feathers on their hands, faces, and body. Pooka care little for social conventions, except perhaps to break them. Style for a pooka can almost always be said to be... unique. They are just as likely to show up at court wearing pajamas as they are courtly garb. And even their courtly wear is often exaggerated, loud, and ostentatious.

Lifestyles: Living a life of freedom and choice, most pooka manage to eke out a living doing whatever it is that they most enjoy. They can often be found as entertainers: actors, street performers, magicians, jugglers, fire-spinners, and so on. They prefer to live in funky, bohemian neighborhoods where their eccentricities are not condemned. Artistic communities and "up-and-coming" neighborhoods are common. Though some perverse pooka prefer to dwell in uptight and even banal places, where their presence breaks up

